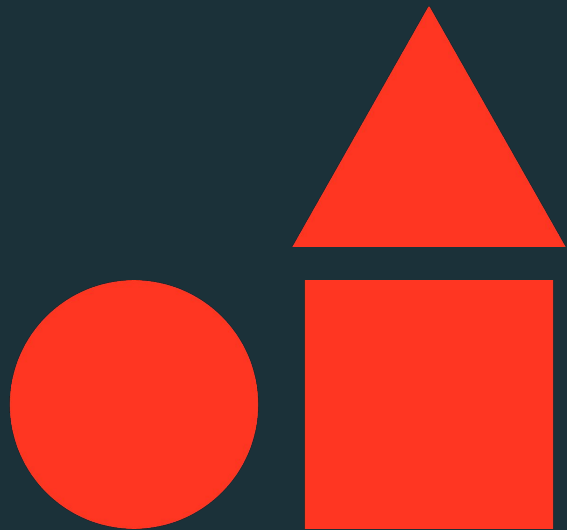


Cost Controls with Serverless in Databricks





Elements of cost management

"I don't want to blow my budget"

4

Entitlements and rate limits

"Intern runs large query over lunch. Am I bankrupt?"

3

Accidental spend prevention

"I need to tell the finance team how much they owe me"

2

Attribution, particularly for charge-backs

"I don't know how much I'm spending"

1

Foundation: Observability and alerting



4 Entitlements and rate limits

3 Accidental spend prevention

2 Attribution, particularly for charge-backs

1 Foundation: Observability and alerting

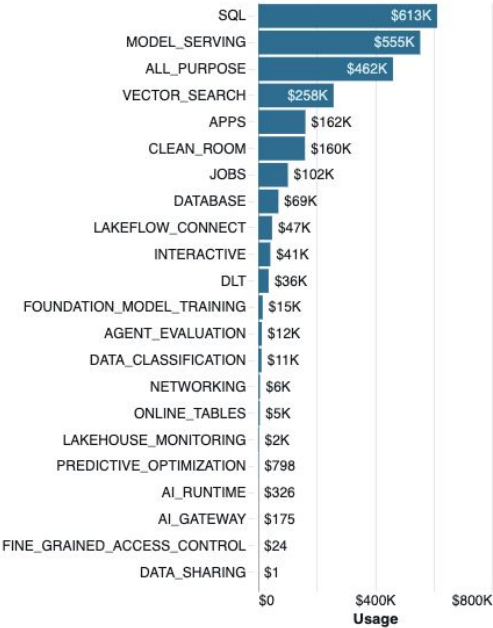


Analyze usage for your account by product, workspace, and identify trends over time.

Group by Key
Group usage data by one of the below dimensions

Product

Usage by Group Key



Total Usage

\$2,556,878
2025-05-01 to 2025-07-30

Forecasted Usage

*Forecast #s do not cross filter, use global filters

\$160,316
2025-07-31 to 2025-08-04

Run Rate Usage
(period type)

\$28,098
per Day

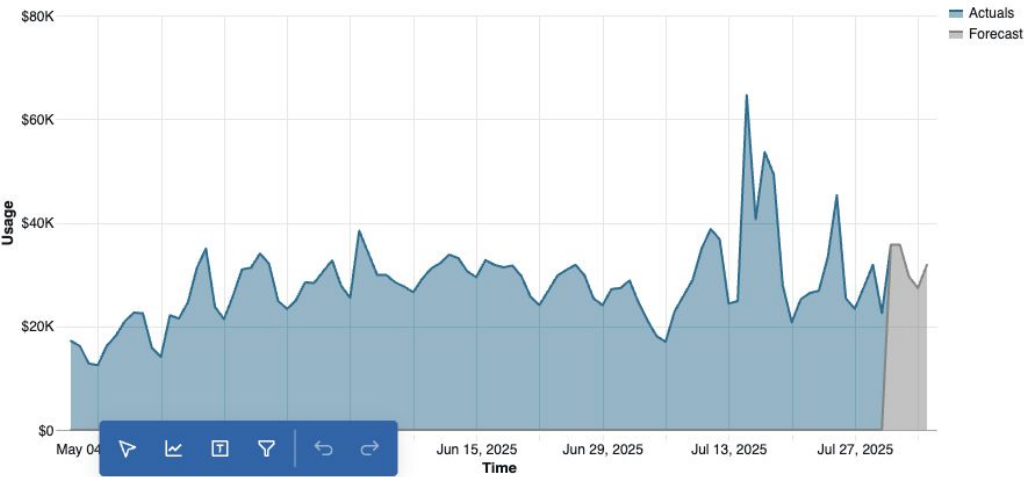
Forecasted Run Rate

(percent increase/decrease from actual run rate)

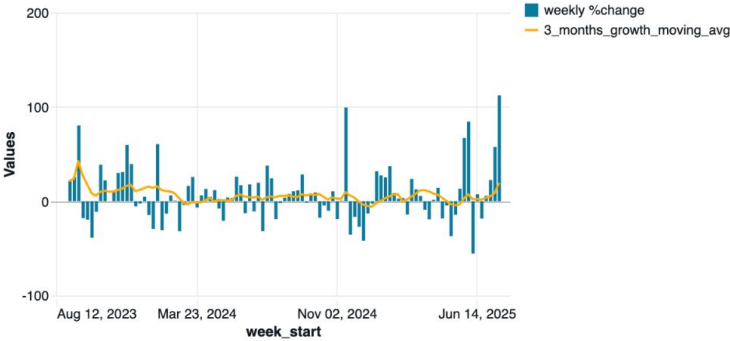
\$32,063
14%

Total Usage Over Time

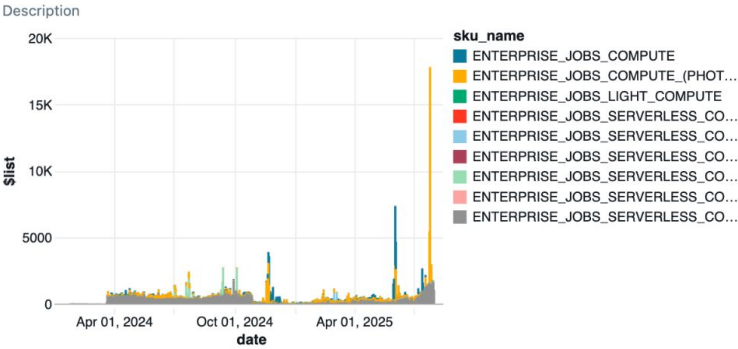
*Does not cross filter, use global filters or look at the below visual to look at cross filtered values



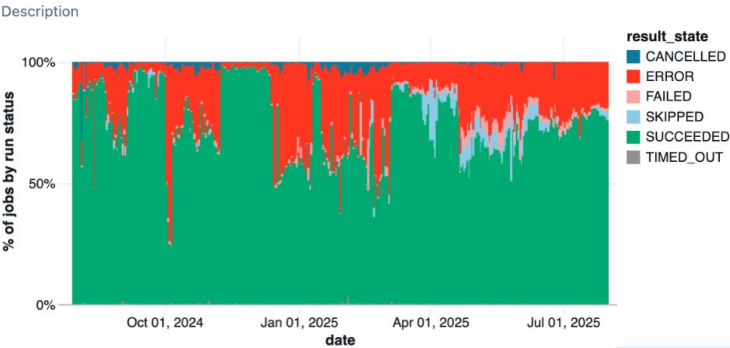
WoW \$list %change



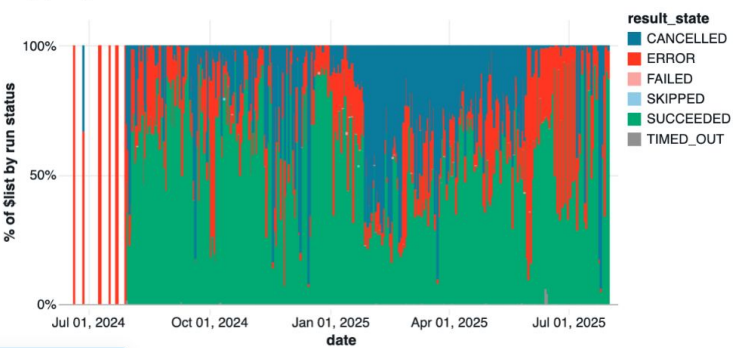
Daily \$list by SKU



Daily Run Status Distribution



Daily \$list by Run Status Distribution



Budgets

Monthly dollar allocations set by billing administrators

Visualize usage over time, alerted by email when limits are met

Budgets segmented by tag, workspace



Hello,

Your account's current Databricks spend for budget "**hexagon**" triggered an alert. We're informing you so that you can investigate further and take appropriate action.

Budget Name: **hexagon**

Current Spend: **\$1,234,567,890.76**

Budgeted Amount: **\$1,000,000,000.00**

Percent of Budget Spent: **917.85%**

Percent of Budget Period Elapsed: **96.77%**

Budget Filters:

{}

For more usage details, please visit your [Databricks account console](#).

If you no longer wish to receive these notifications, please modify the budget or contact your Databricks administrator.
(BudgetId: 24dbf9b7-3ed3-42d1-a55e-9a33c53c7b24)

<https://docs.databricks.com/aws/en/admin/account-settings/budgets>



4 Entitlements and rate limits

3 Accidental spend prevention

2 Attribution, particularly for charge-backs

1 Foundation: Observability and alerting



Tags

Giving context to objects and spend

Key/value pairs applied to most objects in Databricks

Used for billing, cost attribution, and possibly automation

Propagated to cloud resources, propagated from job definition to compute

Keys (categories to use)

General:

(Everyone should start w/ these)

- Business Unit
- Project
- *(optional)* Environment (dev/test/prod)

High Specificity:

Builder (SI partner name, Built on, etc.), Version, Role, Product, Service, Customer, Other / Custom

Functional:

- deleteAfter / retention
- autoStop
- oncall
- git repository



Cluster Policies

Standardizing Classic compute usage

Constraints as JSON, in-UI (public preview)

Enforce tags, restrict GPUs, dbu_per_hour ceiling

Best practices: Not overly-restrictive, should be future proof

```
{
  "custom_tags.CostCenter": {
    "type": "fixed",
    "value": "Engineering"
  },
  "node_type_id": {
    "type": "allowlist",
    "values": ["i3.xlarge", "i3.2xlarge"]
  },
  "dbus_per_hour": {
    "type": "range",
    "maxValue": 4
  }
}
```



Usage Policies

Tags for attributing Serverless usage

Workspace admins create and grant access

Users select when launching compute

Create budget policy

[Learn more](#)

General

Name

cmeg-ssa

Workspaces

The workspaces that this budget policy applies to. If empty, the policy applies to all workspaces.

Select workspaces

Tags

Used for attribution. Serverless budget policies only support fixed tags.

Tag	Value	
cost_center	611	
vertical	cmeg	
team	ssa	
project	cost-savings	

+ Add tag

Create



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Query/Job Spillover prevention

Compute Type	Configuration / Mechanism	Description
Databricks SQL	STATEMENT_TIMEOUT	A session parameter that sets a timeout in seconds for SQL statements. 2 days by default. Set at workspace level by admins.
Serverless all-purpose and Classic standard	spark.databricks.execution.timeout	A Spark configuration to set a timeout for the execution of a query. Default = 2.5 hours
Classic all-purpose	Query Watchdog	Detects and terminates queries which exceed limits on output explosion, query time, number of rows produced per task.
Serverless	Per-workload spending limits	Serverless quotas



Compute scaledown

Automatically prevent waste

Classic all-purpose: Auto-termination

Serving endpoints: Scale-to-zero

Databricks SQL Warehouses: Auto-stop

Classic: Autoscaling

LDP: Enhanced autoscaling



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Entitlements

Account Admin

	Role name	Description
☒	Account admin	Can manage workspaces, users & groups, cloud resources and settings. This only indicates direct assignment of the role.
☐	Marketplace admin	Can manage exchanges and listings on the Marketplace. This change might take a few minutes to update.
☐	Billing admin	Can view Budgets and create budget policies. This change might take a few minutes to update.

Serverless compute for Workflows, Notebooks, and Delta Live tables

Enabled ☒

Start up a job, notebook, or pipeline in seconds instead of minutes. At this time, Serverless Jobs, Notebooks, and DLT have unrestricted access to the public Internet.

[Documentation](#)



Entitlements

Workspace Admin

Applies to Classic compute and DBSQL

- On ☒ **Admin access**
Can manage this workspace and its users, groups, resources, and settings
- On ☒ **Workspace access**
Can access data engineering and ML environments
- On ☒ **Databricks SQL access**
Can access SQL environment
- Off ☐ **Consumer access**
Can view and interact with Dashboards and Genie spaces
- On ☒ **Unrestricted cluster creation**
Can create clusters; when disabled, the user is restricted to access granted by cluster policies



Rate limiting

Create policy [Preview](#)

General

Name

policy

Family

Custom

Description

Advanced options ^

Cluster type ⓘ

☒ All-purpose ☒ Jobs ☒ DLT

Max compute resources per user

1

Max DBUs per hour ⓘ

100

AI Gateway ▾

Monitor and secure endpoints. [Learn More](#) [Learn more about billing](#).

☐ **Enable usage tracking**

Enable data usage metrics for this endpoint. [Usage tracking table schema](#).

☐ **Enable inference tables**

Inference tables log all requests and responses into Delta tables managed by Unity Catalog. [Inference table schema](#).

☐ **AI Guardrails** [Preview](#)

Set guardrails to prevent the model from interacting with certain types of content. [Learn more](#).

☒ **Rate limits**

Enforce request rate limits to manage traffic for this endpoint.

QPM ⓘ

 Endpoint ⓘ

10000

[Reset](#)

 User (Default) ⓘ

500

[Reset](#)

Select user, group, or service princ...

No limit

[Add](#)



Serverless Access Controls via Usage Policies

Private preview coming soon

- Requires users to specify a policy when creating a serverless resource.
- Users without a policy assigned to them will not be able to create any serverless resources.
- Note: When workspace admins or users with “unrestricted cluster creation” privileges create serverless resources, they will be able to do so without applying a policy to their resources.

Previews

Manage previews. Learn more about use of [previews](#). More previews will continue to be added to this page. Preview enablement or disablement changes take effect in a few minutes.



Select a phase ▾

Serverless Access Controls

Private Preview

The Serverless Access Controls Private Preview enables admins to enforce that only users with a policy assigned can create serverless resources.

[Documentation](#)  [Send feedback](#) 

Off ☐



Serverless Access Controls via Usage Policies

Private preview coming soon

Workspace settings > Compute > Serverless usage policies >

Create usage policy

[Learn more](#)

General

Name

Workspaces

The workspaces that this usage policy applies to. If empty, the policy applies to all workspaces.

Databricks One Demo (1736539397278284) X * v

Tags

Used for attribution. Serverless usage policies only support fixed tags.

Key	Value	
cost_center	engineering	
Select a key	Select a value	

Create



Serverless Access Controls via Usage Policies

Private preview coming soon

Workspace settings > Compute > Serverless usage policies >

Create usage policy

[Learn more](#)

General

Name

serverless-team

Workspaces

The workspaces that this usage policy applies to. If empty, the policy applies to all workspaces.

Tags

Used for attribution. Serverless usage policies only support fixed tags.

Workspace settings > Compute > Serverless usage policies >

serverless_team

⋮

Edit

Configuration

Permissions

Preview

ⓘ

Permissions control who can edit or use this serverless usage policy. [Learn more](#)

×

Search principals

Grant access

Principal	Permissions
Piyush Singh (piyush.singh@databricks.com)	Serverless usage policy: Manager

